

The Secure Employee Offboarding Checklist

Lock down access before data walks out the door.

The riskiest window in your security is the hour after someone leaves — a departing employee often still has an open session and full access. Work through this checklist for every leaver to close that gap from days to minutes.

1 · The first hour (do these immediately)

- **Disable the account — don't delete it**
Block sign-in but preserve the identity for handover and audit. Delete later if needed.
- **End active sessions, not just future logins**
Force sign-out of the session they're already in — disabling usually only blocks the next login.

2 · Access & data

- **Revoke email, SaaS and shared-drive access**
Cover apps outside SSO too — cloud storage, code repos, CRM.
- **Reassign or archive their files**
Transfer ownership of documents, mailboxes and shared assets to a manager.

3 · Device & secrets

- **Secure the device**
Lock or remotely wipe company hardware; confirm no local copies of sensitive data remain.
- **Rotate shared secrets**
Change any shared passwords, API keys or service credentials the person knew.

4 · Compliance

- **Log every offboarding action**
Record who did what, when, and to which account — for compliance and any later investigation.
- **Confirm completion with a second person**
A quick two-person check catches the one drive or session everyone misses.

Automate all of this with Astra

Astra is an AI System Administrator that turns this checklist into one click: it disables a leaver's local account, forces them out of their active Windows session (matched by security ID), blocks re-login, and writes every action to an audit trail — all in the admin-only approval tier.

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